

Agency

Automation

Stop Losing Quote Requests to Slow Follow-Up

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The Exact Automation Blueprint Punctual Plumbers Uses to Respond in Minutes, Not Hours

The Problem You Know Too Well

It's 7:47 PM. A homeowner in Ballito messages your WhatsApp: "Geyser burst. Need someone NOW."

You're on a job site. Hands dirty. Phone in the bakkie.

By the time you see it at 8:15 PM, they've already called three other plumbers. Job lost.

This happens 3-5 times a week for the average KZN trade business.

The Numbers Don't Lie

Metric	Before Automation	After Automation
Avg. response time	4.2 hours	**4 minutes**
Quote-to-job conversion	23%	**41%**
After-hours jobs captured	12%	**67%**
Admin hours/week	8-12 hrs	**1.5 hrs**

Source: Punctual Plumbers internal data, 6-month comparison

The 3 Automations You Can Build This Week

1. WhatsApp -> Instant Quote Acknowledgment (15 min setup)

Tools: WhatsApp Business API (or Twilio) + Make (formerly Integromat)

The Flow:

Customer WhatsApps -> Make webhook captures -> Auto-reply: "Got it! [Name] will call within 15 min" ->

Creates job card in Google Sheet/Airtable -> Sends you push notification with address & details

Template Message:

> "Thanks for reaching out, {{Name}}! We've logged your {{issue}} at {{address}}. [Owner Name] is on a job but will call you within 15 minutes. Reference: JOB-{{timestamp}}"

Why it works: Customer feels heard instantly. You get structured data. Zero manual typing.

2. Quote Follow-Up Sequence That Runs While You Sleep (30 min setup)

Tools: Make + Gmail/Outlook + WhatsApp

The Flow:

Quote sent (via email/WhatsApp) -> Make watches for "Sent" status ->

Day 1, 10 AM: "Hi {{Name}}, just checking -- any questions on the quote for {{job}}?"

Day 3, 2 PM: "Hey {{Name}}, quote for {{job}} expires Friday. Happy to adjust scope if needed."

Day 5, 9 AM: "Last call on {{job}} quote -- locking in material prices today. Let me know?"

Pro tip: Include a "Book Site Visit" Calendly link in every follow-up.

Result: Punctual Plumbers recovered R187K in otherwise-lost quotes in month 1.

3. After-Hours Lead Capture + Morning Handoff (20 min setup)

Tools: WhatsApp Business away message + Make + Google Sheets

The Flow:

After 6 PM / Before 7 AM: WhatsApp auto-reply triggers ->

"Thanks for messaging! We're off-site but your request is logged.

We'll call by 8 AM. For emergencies, call [emergency number]."

-> Make captures: name, number, message, timestamp ->

Adds to "Morning Call List" Google Sheet ->

You open sheet at 7 AM, tap-to-call each lead

Bonus: Add a "Urgency" dropdown in the sheet (Emergency / Today / This Week) so you prioritize.

Your "Start This Week" Checklist

Task	Time	Done?
Set up WhatsApp Business auto-reply (after-hours)	10 min	
Create Make account (free tier = 1,000 ops/mo)	5 min	
Build Webhook -> Auto-reply scenario	15 min	
Build Quote Follow-Up scenario	30 min	
Build Morning Handoff sheet + scenario	20 min	
Test with 3 real leads	30 min	
Total	**~1.5 hours**	

The "No-Code" Stack We Recommend (All Free to Start)

Need	Tool	Free Tier
Automation engine	**Make**	1,000 ops/mo
Database/Job board	**Airtable**	1,000 records
WhatsApp messaging	**Twilio** / WhatsApp Business App	\$0 (app) / pay-per-msg (API)
Scheduling	**Calendly**	Free
Forms/Quote builder	**Tally.so**	Unlimited free

Monthly cost at scale: ~R500-800/mo (Twilio API + Make Pro)

Want Us to Build It For You?

You've got a business to run. Pipes to fix. Geysers to replace.

Book a free 30-minute AI Strategy Call and we'll:

- Audit your current lead flow (15 min)
- Show you the exact Make scenarios pre-built for trades (10 min)
- Give you a copy-paste deployment plan -- or we build it turnkey (5 min)

No pitch. No pressure. Just a clearer path to more jobs.

-> Book Your Free Call Here

One More Thing: The WhatsApp QR Card

Print this. Stick it on your bakkie. Put it on every invoice.

WHATSAPP US FOR A QUOTE [QR CODE -> Your WhatsApp] "Geyser burst? Blocked drain? Message us -- we reply in minutes, not hours." Punctual Plumbers 082 XXX XXXX
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Generates 2-3 qualified leads/week per vehicle. Cost: R150 for laminated cards.

Agency -- Custom Automation for South African Businesses

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